

- 8.c) Compare and contrast the functionalist approaches of Bronislaw Malinowski and A.R. Radcliffe-Brown. What were their key contributions and criticisms? (15 marks)

Biological Functional by Malinowski &
Structural functionalism by Radcliffe Brown
 are two functionalist approaches

<u>Biological Functionalism</u>	<u>Structural Functionalism</u>
① <u>Need</u> : Organic / psychological of impulses which need to be satisfied	① <u>Need</u> : As necessary to ensure maintenance of society.
② <u>Function</u> : Satisfaction of above impulses through <u>culturally approved method</u> .	② <u>Fn</u> : Maintenance of social structure.
③ <u>Social Institution</u> : Exist to provide for primary needs secondary, integrative needs	③ Exist for <u>preoccurrence</u> of <u>social activity</u> for social structure stability.
④ Influence of <u>Frazer's Golden Bough</u>	④ Durkheim idea of <u>pre-social fact</u>
⑤ <u>Magia</u> exists to ensure that anxiety is reduced	⑤ Religion exists to ensure that in <u>social relations</u> stability opposition

Malinowski's key contributions were:

- ① Works: "Argonauts of Western Pacific"
"Scientific Study of Culture"
- ② Brought Participant Observation in anthropology.
- ③ Fieldwork in multiple institutions amongst Trobrandians: Religion, Magic, Economy etc.
- ④ Brought Economic Anthropology as a field. → Kula Ring study
- ⑤ Raised need of anthropologists to learn local language.
- ⑥ "Theory of Needs" to understand culture

Criticisms

- ① Gluckmann said his work is crude materialism
- ② Annette Weiner ⇒ Didn't pay attention to study of power, gender dynamics.
- ③ Ignored role of colonialism in culture change
- ④ Ahistorical in nature.
- ⑤ Generalization of specific study

Key contributions of Brown →

- ① Works: Structure & Function in Primitive Society
'Andaman Islanders'
- ② Brought Durkheim idea of society into anthropology.
- ③ 2 types of social structure
 - General: What is ideal
 - Actual: What is reality.
- ④ Descent Theory of Kinship & understanding of kinship terminology → explained how in simple societies with large no. of relatives it is used to ensure relations.
- ⑤ Kinship Behaviour for social stability
 - Joking
 - Avoidance.

Criticism of his work

- ① Ahistoric / static
- ② DM Lewis ⇒ Data manipulation is synchronic studies
- ③ Justifies social pathologies like caste
- ④ Overharmonious view of society with no conflict ⇒ Pipankar Gupta show caste is change today and have "muddled hierarchies"

Both researchers enriched field of anthropology with their work.